



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Wednesday, 10th December, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,
Parliament House, at 1:13 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

ABSENCE OF THE SPEAKER

Clerk to Parliament (Mr Ebenezer Ahumah Djietror): Hon Members, this is to inform you of the unavoidable absence of Mr Speaker and to also indicate to you that in accordance with Standing Order 12(2), the First Deputy Speaker would take the Chair and exercise authority of the Speaker in relation to all proceedings until the Rt Hon Speaker resumes the Chair.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 5, *Correction of Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, *correction of Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 9th December 2025.

Page 1...11—

Yes, Hon Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, for your guidance on the page numbered 11, I can see the items numbered 11, 12 and 13 which read, “That this Honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Energy on the allocation...”. Considering the fact that when you read Standing Order 62 (1)(a) and with your permission, I read;

“The Mace shall stand upright before the Table during every sitting of the House, except during a sitting of the Committee of the Whole House or a Consideration Stage of a Bill when the Mace shall stand tilted;”

Mr Speaker, at the time these Motions were being taken, the Mace was not standing upright at the Table and we need guidance as to whether when the Mace was moved, considering what has been stated in Order 62, that the Mace was not in its original position and not standing upright.

Mr Speaker, the Mace was not standing upright; the Mace was not before the Table and considering the provision in Order 62, whether or not those Motions were actually carried because the Standing Orders have made it clear—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You are to correct the *Votes and Proceedings*. Show me, by the *Votes and Proceedings*, the position of the Mace.

Hon Member, I think we are in to correct the *Votes and Proceedings*. So, if you have any matter to raise, let us accordingly correct the *Votes and Proceedings*, so that you can raise the issue.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the *Votes and Proceedings* reflect and capture what is purported to have happened exactly yesterday.

I say “purported”, because, if it is not in the *Official Report*, the *Votes and Proceedings* is subject to correction, per our Rules. So, that is why I am saying that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what do you want me to correct?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the guidance I seek from you is that, I think that this should be expunged, because it is against Standing Order 62 (1)(a), because the Mace was not in its position. The Mace was not standing upright and I think all these Motions should be expunged—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib, I think you are seeking my guidance. My guidance is that at this stage, we are correcting *Votes and*

Proceedings and not the position of the Mace.

So, we will proceed to correct the *Votes and Proceedings*. Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, yesterday, he and his Members were wearing masks. *[Laughter]* In addition to wearing the black masks, they created a situation where the Marshal and his team came and blocked them. So, I want to find out whether he saw where the Mace was yesterday. *[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 12...14—

Yes, Hon Second Deputy Speaker?

Mr Andrew Asiamah Amoako: Mr Speaker, let me bring you back to the page numbered 7, by your indulgence. Yesterday, I was sitting here with you and I have been marked absent.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, kindly take note.

Page 14...18—

Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you so much.

Mr Speaker, the Motion numbered 41, on the last but one line, I propose we delete the words “by the” written after the word “seconded” because, it has been repeated.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Table, take note.

Page 19...30—

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, briefly, on the page numbered 30, the title, “Mrs” at the item numbered (xxxiii), if we could delete what is there, and properly insert the title “Mrs”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. Table, take note.

Page 31?

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Thursday, 9th December, 2025, as presented and corrected is hereby accepted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, I have the *Official Reports* of 27th November, 2025 and 28th November, 2025.

1:23 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We shall first consider 27th November, 2025. It is for your correction.

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Thursday, 27th November, 2025]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Now the *Official Report* of 28th November, 2025.

[No correction was made to the Official Report of Friday, 28th November, 2025]

Yes, Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I crave your indulgence for us to vary the Order of Business and lay some Papers under items 8 (a), (b), (c), (d), (e).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we have recognised the items and the application made by the Leader of the House, but just to remind the Leader that we have a scheduled engagement with the Minister for Finance at the Committee of the Whole, and we also have the Public Utility and Regulatory Commission (PURC) also scheduled. I am told the PURC is here, but for convenience, so that we cannot have Committee of the Whole and suspend and go into plenary, if we can be assured of the presence or the coming of the Minister for Finance, so that after the engagement with him, we can also have the PURC engagement at the Committee of the Whole. But we do not have a problem. We can start with the laying of these Papers.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Item numbered 8, at the commencement of Public Business, presentation of Papers. Item numbered 8(a), the Hon Minister for the Interior?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister for the Interior is unavoidably absent, but we have the Minister for Roads and Highways here, so if you would indulge us so that the Minister for Roads can lay it on his behalf.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: He is just setting traps for me. Why did he mention the Minister for Roads and Highways' name? He should have called somebody else. Why would he bring the Minister for Roads and Highways into this matter? We would let this pass.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister for Roads and Highways on behalf of the Minister for the Interior, item numbered 8(a)?

PAPERS

By the Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza) on behalf of the Minister for the Interior —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Ministry of the Interior for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Defence and Interior.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, similarly, the Acting Minister for Defence is unavoidably absent. So, again, given that I have realised the potency of using the Minister for Roads and Highways, I will once again crave your indulgence to use the Minister for Roads and Highways to lay item 8(b).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister for Roads and Highways, item numbered 8(b)?

By the Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Governs Agbodza) on behalf of the Minister for Defence —

Annual Statement by the Audit Committee of the Kofi Annan International Peacekeeping Training Centre for the year 2024.

Referred to the Committee on Defence and Interior.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, item numbered 8(c), Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Chairman of the Committee is not immediately available, but I want to crave your indulgence to lay it on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: The Chairman of the Committee on Sanitation, I am aware that the Estimates. Yesterday, they had a field day. They have taken all the Motions with a glee. Majority Leader, what would be the excuse? Is it that they are engaged in a Committee meeting considering the Estimates? Estimates that have already been laid. What is the reason why this particular Chairman is not here? Is he indisposed? What is the problem? There should be professing reasons why the Chairman is not here. We will grant the request, but for the record, the Majority Leader should give us reasons why the Chairman is not here.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, this is not even about Estimates. This is just a mere report of visits that they undertook to certain sanitation infrastructure, of which they are presenting the report. I am just laying it so that it can be taken later by the Chairperson. It is the Chairperson that will take it as a Motion for us to adopt, and at that time, the Chairman will definitely feature to do that. This was just to lay it.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah: Mr Speaker, the Leader of Government Business and the Majority Leader says he is just laying a “mere” Report. There is nothing called a “mere” Report on this Floor. I am invoking Standing Orders 97(3), and I am asking the Leader of the House to give an explanatory Statement, a short one, on the contents of this Report that he is—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, your application is premature.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we will eventually allow him to lay the Report, and it is also because we have a plethora of Reports and referrals that are outstanding, but the word he used, “mere” Report, that is not acceptable, and he is a man of words. The Majority Leader, is a man of words and he should find a synonym for “mere”, that is acceptable to this House.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you can suggest the appropriate word.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I do not have words, he does.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: All right. Suggest to him to use “simple Report”.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, he is the Majority Leader, I am not the Leader. I am a Whip.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Leader, they are asking you to use “simple Report”

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I replace it with an “ordinary Report”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader, you may do so.

By the Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga) on behalf of the Chairman of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Sanitation and Water Resources on Monitoring visits to selected Metropolitan, Municipal and District Assemblies in the Greater Accra and Ashanti Regions to Assess the State of Sanitation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Report has been duly presented. It is for the distribution to Hon Members. Item numbered 8(d).

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Chairman of the Finance Committee is here.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Finance Committee Chairman, you have the floor.

By the Chairman of the Committee —

Report of the Finance Committee on the Request for the Waiver of Import Duties, Import NHIL, Special Import Levy, Value Added Tax, GETFund Levy, ECOWAS Levy, AU Levy and EXIM Levy on the importation of Vehicles with Engine Capacities of up to 2.70cc for Foreign Service Officers returning from postings at Ghana Missions abroad.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Report has been duly presented. It is for distribution to Hon Members. Hon Members, we can take the item numbered 8(e)(i)(ii)(iii)(iv) and (v) together, which would be done by the Chairperson of the Committee.

1:33 p.m.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, not to pre-empt what the Hon Majority Leader will say, but I come under Order 97(3) to request a short explanatory statement on the Report.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Again, the application is premature. When a Member gets up and lays a Paper, it is then that you can ask the Member to give an explanation, but not before laying the Paper.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, we have three Hon Members of the Committee, so we will elect Ms Zuwera Ibrahimah to

lay the Paper on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: All right

By Ms Zuwera Mohammed Ibrahimah on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee—

- i. Report of the Committee on Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration on the Bilateral Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs) and the Government of the Republic of Angola on the Waiver of Visa Requirements for Holders of Diplomatic and Service Passports.
- ii. Report of the Committee on Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration on the Bilateral Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs), and the Government of the Republic of Serbia on the Abolition of Visa Requirements for Holders of Diplomatic and Official (Service) Passports.
- iii. Report of the Committee on Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration on the Bilateral Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs)

and the Government of the People's Democratic Republic of Algeria on the Waiver of Visa Requirements for Holders of Diplomatic and Service Passports.

- iv. Report of the Committee on Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration on the Headquarters Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana (represented by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs) and Afrobarometer.
- v. Report of the Committee on Foreign Affairs and Regional Integration on the Agreement under the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) on the conservation and sustainable use of marine biological diversity of areas beyond national jurisdiction.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We move to the item numbered 9 —

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, before we go to the item numbered 9, may I crave your indulgence and refer to Order 98, which says that:

“A Member, Minister or Head of an Independent Constitutional Body who presented a Paper may withdraw the Paper by leave of the House.”

Mr Speaker, an Agreement was presented by the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources relating to a concession for the mining of lithium in the country. I have indications from the Hon Minister that he wants to withdraw the Agreement. He has travelled outside the jurisdiction in his capacity as the Acting Minister for Environment, Science and Technology. There is a major environmental conference in Nairobi, Kenya, to which the President was invited, and the President has asked him to represent him. He came and sought leave to absent himself to attend to that. But he has asked that his Deputy Minister, Hon Yusif Sulemana, who is here with us, be allowed on his behalf to withdraw the proposed Lithium Agreement.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah: Mr Speaker, ordinarily, we would not be against the request by the Hon Majority Leader, but this is such an important Agreement that has attracted a lot of interest from the public, especially with the reduction of the royalties from 10 per cent to five per cent. We have heard from the Civil Society Organisations (CSOs), we have heard from a lot of mining experts in this country that Ghana ought to have negotiated this Agreement and obtained far better terms if the government of the day so wished. So, I would have expected the Hon Minister to have even come here with a very well-written Statement with regard to this withdrawal because it is very important.

This House passed a resolution and we believe that the terms that were agreed by the previous administration were the best. We listened to Sir Sam Jonah and a lot of mining experts who said that the Agreement that was entered into was in the best interest of this country, but we do not know what led to the reduction in the royalties from 10 per cent to 5 per cent and what has necessitated the withdrawal of this Agreement. I want to believe that my good Friend and Brother from Bole Bamboi, from the President's constituency, wearing the big shoes of the President in the Chamber, will come and explain to us why today of all days, he has decided to withdraw this Agreement. Is it because of the public backlash? What has changed?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Patrick Yaw Boamah, I think you are completely out of order. You should wait. If the person who is withdrawing the Paper or the Agreement is unable to proffer reasons, then you would be justified in making the points that you are making. But before he is given the opportunity, and at the time that application is being made for him to be given the opportunity, with all due respect —

Mr Boamah: Mr Speaker, we have Mr Mahama Ayariga as the Hon Majority Leader and you know his tactics. I saw him on the day I did my submission. I know what he would have done. So, I anticipated him and said what I needed to say. On anticipation, I know he would read Order 105. I know him. So, Mr Sulemana should not rely on your Leader. They should come and tell us why they are withdrawing this.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The application is by the leave of the House.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I think the Hon Member is on all fours. He is right and maybe it is the semantics and the way he puts out his expression. Order 98 is clear, and the crux of Order 98 is by the leave of this House. We as an integral part of this House, are requesting of him that he would not only come to withdraw. He must withdraw and profess why he is withdrawing.

1:43 p.m.

Mr Speaker, we are not out of the Orders. We are fully on all fours. I know him; he is preparing. He has put things together. He should just give us reasons why— Is it a response to the call by Civil Society Organisations (CSOs) and the public, or they are withdrawing to go and tidy up the Agreement? This House needs to know, and also for the records. Mr Yusif Sulemana, this is not beyond you; you can do it, so please do it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us do things in a timely manner. The application the Hon Majority Leader is making is for leave to allow the Hon Deputy Minister, instead of the Minister, to do the withdrawal. So, at this particular stage, until and unless that application is granted, whatever is being said is premature. I get the sense of the House.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Majority Leader has made an application for the Deputy Minister to make the withdrawal. We are not

litigating it; we support it. Mr Speaker, we are waiting on you to grant that application.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, the application is hereby granted. Hon Deputy Minister, you have the floor.

**Withdrawal of the Mining Lease
Agreement Between GoG and Barari
DV Gh. Ltd for the Mining of
Lithium and other minerals at
Mankessim**

Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources (Alhaji Yusif Sulemana): Mr Speaker, I am grateful. I rise under Order 98 of the Standing Orders of the House to seek your leave and the leave of the House to withdraw the Mining Lease Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana, represented by the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources, and Barari DV Ghana Limited, for the mining of lithium and other minerals at Mankessim. We are talking about 42.63 kilometres square in the Mfantseman District of the Central Region. Mr Speaker, I have been asked to provide the reasons for which we are withdrawing this. This Agreement was laid before the House on Tuesday, 11th November, 2025, and was referred to the Committee on Lands and Natural Resources for consideration and to report to this House. The reason for the withdrawal of this Agreement is to enable the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources to undertake further consultations with the

relevant stakeholders prior to re-presenting it to this honourable House. Listening to my Colleagues on the other Side, they have actually made my work easy. They have given reasons for which there is a need for us to withdraw this Agreement. The Hon Member says that he has listened to very prominent people, numerous Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs) and Civil Society Organisations, and they are all calling on us to do further work on this very important Agreement. It is for that reason that the listening Minister and the listening Government have decided to withdraw this Agreement and undertake further work, involving the Minority, so that we can move together.

Mr Speaker, I therefore seek your leave. Thank you.

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah (NPP—Okaikoi Central): Hon Deputy Minister and Government, we told you so. We did. We told you that you did not undertake wider consultation in this Agreement that you brought, and you are now telling us that you have gone around to listen to prominent people; you have gone around to listen to CSOs and because they are bashing you—and you have gone around to listen to experts in this industry. What did they do in the first place? They did not consult anybody. They came to this House and we told them that they brought a flawed Agreement that was not in the best interest of Ghana. They said they had the numbers, and would pass it. We voiced our objections, but they insisted on their way. And now, they are back here to withdraw it. We told them so.

Majority Leader (Mr Mahama Ayariga): Mr Speaker, it is important to understand the context of this Agreement. When the Agreement was proposed to this House by the New Patriotic Party (NPP) Administration, world price for lithium was very high, and therefore, we demanded higher royalties. That is a fact. After the NPP left office and we took over, the world market price of lithium collapsed. Therefore, it became a disincentive for anyone to invest in mining lithium in this country. That is why there was a need to lower the royalty rate in order to incentivise anybody who wanted to mine lithium in this country.

Mr Speaker, why are we withdrawing this Agreement? We are withdrawing this Agreement because there is a proposal coming back to this House for us to review the royalties for our natural resources. For instance, as we speak, gold prices have soared. They are very high, but we are still collecting very low rates of royalties. So, the proposal is to change and structure our entire royalties' regime to be pegged at world market prices of the minerals. So, for instance, if we are taking 5 per cent for gold and gold price is US\$30, when gold price goes to US\$200, we must be taking much, much higher. But because the Agreements that come have fixed royalties, and then we approve them in this House, when there is a change in the world market price, the ministers cannot run back immediately to amend the royalties component of the Agreement.

So, we want to bring in a legislation that generally fixes every mineral resource in this country's royalty rates

that are pegged at world market prices of the item. Today, Ghana would have been reaping so much from gold, given the increase in world gold prices. The same with lithium. If the world market price is very low and we want to incentivise people, we may still maintain a lower rate of royalties. But when the market changes and the prices go up, automatically, the person mining should pay to Government of Ghana a higher rate of royalties. It is the decision to bring this broader legislation, fixing royalties, that has necessitated the withdrawal of this one, so that when the legislation comes, the legislation would determine the royalties, not just for lithium but for every other mineral that is going to be mined in this country. This is what is really informing the decision to withdraw this as the Minister works his way to come for a revision of our current royalty regime.

Yes, we have listened to the civil society and we have listened to experts in the industry. We are still convinced that when world prices for an item is low, you need to incentivise an investor to invest. But when the prices go up, the investor must also reward the country for giving them the opportunity to mine the resource in the country. That is the basic principle going forward that will inform the royalty regime of this country.

Mr Speaker, it is on this basis that we seek the leave of this House for the Agreement to be withdrawn so that when we carry out the reforms that we are considering, we can have a uniform royalties' regime for all natural resources. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Darko-Mensah?

Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah, why do you want to speak twice on this issue?

Mr Boamah: Mr Speaker, not to cut in, but that would be a very tall order for the Government of the day, because they will be veering into areas of regulatory expropriation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Patrick Yaw Boamah, with all due respect, please resume your seat. Yes, you have the floor.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi): Mr Speaker, first and foremost, sometimes they need to listen to our Side. In most cases, they have always looked at politics away from businesses. In fact, when we brought the Bill and the Agreement here last year, they fought us until this year when the communities themselves started fighting against them. Mr Speaker, all over the country, where we have commodities, we have seen how those towns have developed: Obuasi, Tarkwa, and other places.

1:53 p.m.

In every agreement, there is always a carried interest, an investment agreement and a development agreement. We have the windfall taxes that are usually applied when the prices of gold or whatever commodities go up. So, every Ghanaian or every government knows these things happen all the time. So, for them to tell us that they are withdrawing it because prices are now increasing, I

beg to differ, and I believe that they need to apologise to us. That is not the reason.

If they want to change the laws of the country, they can always bring it. Sometimes they even come at midnight to change the tax system. Why can they not do the same with their Act that gives us the percentages for the royalties and the rest? So, Mr Speaker, I believe that the National Democratic Congress (NDC) should learn that when they make a mistake, they should come clean and say they made a mistake instead of always trying to change the agenda and trying to create the impression that nothing has gone wrong.

I believe that it is time Ghanaians understood that the new order is coming to town, and the order is that every community that has mineral resources wants to see development in their communities. Unfortunately, most of the time when government takes the money to Accra, hardly do we see these things going back into their communities. So, these days, unlike in the past when only Accra was speaking, today, the communities are also speaking. They should understand that that is one of the key reasons they are coming back to this House. This is because we gave their communities a better deal with that agreement than what the NDC currently has in this House.

We are happy that they are coming to withdraw it and bring a better agreement so that the communities of this country benefit not only from lithium, but from others. At least, we gave them 10 per cent. What they brought to us is five per

cent and sliding scale. What is sliding scale? The minimum should be 10 per cent or 15 per cent, then we know that something better is going back into the communities to develop them. Mr Speaker, with these few words, I would like to support the idea that they are coming to withdraw it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, based on the phrase that the Hon Member made that they are happy that the Agreement is being withdrawn, I gather the sense of the House that we are not opposed to the withdrawal of the Agreement. So, Hon Members, I intend to grant the leave of the House for the Agreement to be accordingly withdrawn.

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh): Mr Speaker, with respect, I just have some concluding remarks and then we can draw the curtains.

We are not opposed them. We want them to withdraw it—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Minority Chief Whip, let me hear you.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, first of all, I think that clearly, our Colleagues are eating a humble pie. There is no shame in this. They are gladly eating a humble pie. We had warned and alerted them ahead of time that the path they were blazing was a slippery path and therefore, they needed to change course. Eventually, they listened to us. Beautiful! That is how we want to proceed as a country.

But the point I want to make really is that, I am an environmentalist, so I know the importance of lithium. Ghana, as at independence, our per capita income was the same as Indonesia. Indonesia has 10 round lithium. Now, lithium constitutes about 70 per cent of the accessories of renewable energy, that is, solar panels and all that. Now we have a Ministry of Energy and Green Transition, so if we are withdrawing this Agreement, we should be looking at how we can transition to ensure that we, as a country, can benefit highly from the lithium farm. That way, it does not become a resource curse to this country.

So, in the context of their reset, when they are bringing it back, we want to see this finding expression. Hon Sulemana is nodding his head. He should nod his head well. We want to see them amending the Agreement so that for once, mobile phone accessories — *[Interruption]* So, Ghana is gladly transitioning, and I am saying, when they are bringing the Agreement, they should let it find an expression.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, hold it. Hon Kennedy Nyarko Osei, why are you turning your back to the Mace?

Yes, Minority Chief Whip, you have the floor.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, these are matters I do not want to be repetitive on. I know the Hon Yusif is a listening Minister. He should convey this to his boss. He was a former Leader in this House. We know him. He is also a listening person.

We just want a situation where it will not just be resource found and then we are just exporting. What can we do? I hope that with the way Hon Yusif is nodding your head, he is listening for good. Mr Speaker, it is important. Indonesia and China have set the example. There is a lot we can do with this lithium. It should not just be one of the minerals that we have found and just be exporting. Let us think about how we can make good use of these minerals to the benefit of the people of this country. I thank you, Mr Speaker, for the space granted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Members, we can all realise from the sense of the House that there is no opposition to the application to have the Agreement withdrawn. Accordingly, leave is hereby granted.

[Agreement withdrawn by leave of the House]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leader, do we move to the item numbered 9 now and take (b) and (c)? In the meantime, permit me to acknowledge the presence of students in our midst. We have Kuntunse M/A Basic School. The leader is Victoria Doh, head facilitator. They are from Amasaman, and are 67 in number.

[Pupils of Kuntunse M/A Basic School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We have Pentecost University Law Students' Union, led by Samson Addo and Kennedy Amoako who are the presidents. They are from Sowutuom and are 70 in number.

[Students of Pentecost University Law Students' Union were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then we have Messiah Tsidkenu School, led by Philomena Azila, administrator, and they are from Kpone Katamanso. They are 100 in number.

[Pupils of Messiah Tsidkenu School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: On behalf of the House, I welcome you. May you have a fruitful stay. Thank you very much. You may resume your seats.

Yes, Majority Leader—

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we had earlier informed the Majority Leadership of an earlier call for a Committee of the Whole. Next week, we are likely to rise, and there are outstanding matters that have not been resolved. The Majority Leader agrees. We had earlier also called for Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC). They been here since morning. I know he wants to call for other Businesses to be prosecuted, but these matters are important. Can we break into a Committee of the Whole, deal with the PURC, and then we will have to wait for —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Rest assured, we will do that once there was some agreement at the pre-Sitting meeting.

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is not in the Chamber, but his Deputy is here. In

keeping with our practice, I would crave your indulgence for us to allow the Deputy to present the item numbered 9(b).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Deputy Minority Leader, the application is that the Deputy Finance Minister should do the presentation of the Bill on behalf of the Minister.

Ms Patricia Appiagyei: Please, we are in agreement.

2:03 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Deputy Minister for Finance? The item numbered 9 (b): Presentation and First Reading of Bills.

BILLS — FIRST READING

Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025

AN ACT to amend the Bank of Ghana Act, 2002 (Act 612) and provide for related matters.

Presented by the Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) on behalf of the Minister. Read the First time; referred to the Committee on Economy and Development.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, can the Deputy Minister give us a brief explanation about what amendment he seeks to make on that.

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP): Mr Speaker, there are only a few amendments we are seeking to make to the Bank of Ghana Act, 2002. It is to strengthen the autonomy, the independence of the Central Bank, and to limit the monetary financing by the Central Bank. These are the main points of the amendment that we are seeking to make to the Act. Thank you.

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, a slight amendment to our *Order Paper*. The item numbered 9 (c) is to be presented by the Minister for Transport, not the Minister for Roads and Highways. Mr Speaker, subject to that amendment of our *Order Paper*, the Minister for Transport is here and ready to present the item numbered 9 (c).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Leader, you are right. It should be Minister for Transport, not Roads and Highways.

Yes, Minister for Transport?

Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill, 2025

AN ACT to amend the Road Traffic Act, 2004 (Act 683) to provide for the use of motorcycles, tricycles and quadracycles for commercial purposes, the development of standards for seat belts and other safety equipment and for related matters.

Presented by the Minister for Transport (Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari). Read the First time; referred to the Committee on Roads and Transportation.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, the item numbered 9 (c) as amended is to be done by the Minister for Transport. Mr Speaker, can the Minister give us an explanation on the Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill, 2025 since it is a big amendment.

Minister for Transport (Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari) (MP): Mr Speaker, the Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill, 2025, seeks to sanitise the road transport services sector. Recently, we have been having a lot of issues that have to do with our road users, and this Bill seeks to bring about some stricter punishment to road users, bring about safety measures to the road users, and also provide for the effective and efficient usage of our roads. The Bill seeks to provide for limits in the determination of alcohol concentration in our drivers. Lately, we have realised that a lot of accidents are due to human factors that include drivers driving under alcohol and under stress. This Bill seeks to bring about the limitation from 0.08 per cent of alcohol concentration in drivers to 0.05 per cent. This, we believe, will help sanitise our roads.

Again, Mr Speaker, it also seeks to provide for the usage of motorcycles and tricycles for commercial purposes, for fare-paying activities. This will create

jobs for our youth who are desirous of earning a living or have employment within the road transport sector. Mr Speaker, it also seeks to reduce the age limit from 25 years to 21 years for those who are interested in having employment in the transport sector. All these are determined to develop a standard in our transport system, especially our protective gear. This will bring about improvement in the transport sector. We believe that when this Bill is considered and passed by this House, it will help us to control, monitor, and discipline the recalcitrant drivers and also create jobs for our people.

Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity.

Deputy Majority Leader (Mr George Kweku Ricketts-Hagan): Thank you, Mr Speaker. We want to vary the *Order Paper* and turn our attention to the Motion numbered 44.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we have been cooperative. We have to break into Committee of the Whole. It is past 2:00 p.m., and we are meeting two important entities.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Chief Whip, I take the responsibility for it. I would request that the Second Deputy Speaker takes the Committee of the Whole. This is because I have a Committee meeting at 3:00 p.m. So, we would break into a Committee of the Whole appropriately.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we will defer to you but they should know that this was not one of the things we discussed at Conclave. When they spring a surprise like that, it affects us. We had agreed that when we take these items, we would proceed to have Committee of the Whole, and the PURC will meet them. This was not spoken to. They never mentioned this Business.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Your point is well noted. The item numbered 44, Motion, Minister for Finance.

BILL — SECOND READING

Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025

Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP) *on behalf of the Minister for Finance:* Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu — *rose* —

Second Deputy Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong): Mr Speaker, I keep advising Hon Habib on these matters. Order 215 (3) is clear on this matter. The Chairman or any Member of the Committee can present the Committee's Report. He keeps repeating himself on this matter.

Mr Speaker, I personally presented two copies to the Leadership of the Minority Side. I gave them a copy, and

they are saying they do not have a copy. It has been loaded on the console. Technology, we are talking about virtual asset, and this is a virtual report. I gave them hard copies and soft copies and they are complaining. They should check the console. The Hon First Deputy Minority Whip is a young parliamentarian yet he is behaving like a "BBC" man. It is loaded onto the console.

2:12 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Acheampong, hold it. Yes, Hon Habib Iddrisu?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, ordinarily, I will not do this. My Colleague is a leader of this House. Mr Speaker, you said Chairman of the Committee. The first thing he should have done under our Standing Orders as he is not the Chairperson of the Committee, was to seek your leave as the Vice Chairman to move the Motion.

Secondly, Mr Speaker, we are now seeing the Report on the console, and there are no hard copies available. So, before he proceeds, he should seek your leave to present the Report since he is not the Chairperson.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The point is well noted. Leave is hereby granted. Hon Richard Acheampong, you may proceed to present the Report of the Committee.

Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee: Mr Speaker, thank you very much. I am the Vice Chairperson of the Committee not the Chairperson.

Mr Speaker, I call on *Hansard* to capture the entire Report as having been presented while I read the rationale for the Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025 before the House.

Introduction

The Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025, was presented to Parliament by Hon Minister for Finance, Mr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, in accordance with Article 174 of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 165 of the House and read the first time on Thursday, 13th November, 2025.

Subsequently, the Bill was referred to the Finance Committee for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and Standing Order 226 of Parliament.

Deliberations

The Committee, in considering the Bill, met with the Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem, technical teams from the Ministry of Finance, Bank of Ghana and the Securities and Exchange Commission. Officials from the Legislative Drafting Division of the

Ministry of Justice and Attorney-General's Department were also in attendance to assist.

Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents in the consideration of the Bill:

- i. The 1992 Constitution
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament
- iii. Payment Systems and Services Act, 2019 (Act 987),
- iv. Banks and Specialised Deposit-Taking Act, 2016 (Act 930),
- v. Non-Bank Financial Institutions Act, 2008 (Act 774),
- vi. Anti-Money Laundering Act, 2020 (Act 1044),
- vii. Bank of Ghana Act, 2002 (Act 612)
- viii. Securities Industry Act, 2016 (Act 929)
- ix. Companies Act, 2019 (Act 992)
- x. Private Partnership Act, 1962 (Act 152)

Rationale

The virtual asset economy is reshaping the financial landscape of the Country in a rapid, informal and often invisible manner. Ghana ranks twenty-ninth globally in the adoption of cryptocurrency, with 3.1 million users of cryptocurrency.

Stable coins operate as *de facto* foreign exchange instruments, peer-to-peer groups facilitate unregulated transfers and young Ghanaians interact with virtual asset platforms without any institutional guidance. Although these shifts are happening outside the perimeter of the formal financial system, the effects are beginning to echo within the financial system.

Recognising the growing prominence of virtual assets in global financial markets, the Bank of Ghana, in August 2024, after engagement with various stakeholders, issued draft guidelines on digital assets to provide regulatory measures and solicit feedback from industry and the public. While the draft guidelines on digital assets remain instrumental in setting the regulatory tone for the regulation and supervision of virtual asset service providers in the Country, there is the need for further clarity and legal certainty with regards to the provision of virtual assets in the Country.

Currently, there is no legal framework specifically enacted for the regulation and supervision of virtual asset service providers in the country. Existing legal frameworks such as the Bank of Ghana Act, 2002 (Act 612), the Anti-Money Laundering Act, 2020 (Act 1044) and the Payment Systems and Services Act, 2019 (Act 987), do not provide for the regulation and supervision of virtual asset service provider in the country. Absence of regulation could potentially undermine currency stability, weaken monetary policy effectiveness, encourage capital flight and increase

consumer exposure to global financial risks. It is therefore crucial for Ghana to introduce a regulatory regime to deal specifically with virtual assets.

The regulation of virtual asset service providers will create a safe, transparent and accountable virtual asset ecosystem that protects consumers, prevents illicit activities, promotes regulatory oversight and financial stability. Moreover, Ghana is preparing towards the Third Round Mutual Evaluation exercise on Money Laundering, Terrorism Financing and Proliferation Financing to be conducted by the Inter-Governmental Action Group Against Money Laundering in West Africa with the onsite scheduled for January 2026. Ghana is expected to put in place appropriate measures to fight money laundering, terrorism financing and proliferation financing, particularly in the area of virtual assets and virtual asset service provision, in line with the standards of the Financial Action Task Force.

The Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025 therefore seeks to provide a legal framework for the effective regulation and supervision of virtual asset service provision in the Country.

Object of the Bill

The object of the Bill is to regulate the provision of virtual asset services in the Country.

Content/Structure of the Bill

The Bill contains seventy-three (73) clauses indicated as follows:

Clause 1 deals with the application of the Bill.

Clauses 2 to 5 provide for the relevant regulatory authorities under the Bill

Clause 6 specifies the requirements for qualification to provide a virtual asset service

Clauses 7 to 13 deal with the registration of virtual asset service providers

Clauses 14 to 20 provide for the licensing of virtual asset service providers

Clauses 21 to 35 deal with general requirements for virtual asset service providers

Clause 36 sets out requirement of virtual asset services provider to maintain effective and efficient cybersecurity measures and to submit a cybersecurity report to the relevant regulatory authority in the form and frequency determined by the relevant regulatory authority

Clauses 37 to 42 provide for requirements in respect of securities business, virtual asset issuance, virtual asset custody services, virtual asset trading platforms and the issuance and transfer of shares.

Clauses 43 to 50 provide for a sandbox license

Clauses 51 to 58 provide for matters related to the enforcement of the Bill

Clauses 59 to 65 deal with the receivership of a virtual asset service provider

Clause 66 excludes the provision of the Companies Act 2019 (Act 992), the Corporate Insolvency or liquidation from applying to the winding up or liquidation of a virtual asset service provider

Clauses 67 to 73 deal with the miscellaneous provisions

Observations

Mitigation of Global Financial Risk

The Committee observed that emerging trends in our global financial markets including the introduction of virtual asset services pose risks to Ghanaians as they interact with such platforms without institutional guidance and regulatory framework. There is the need to provide regulatory measures to mitigate such risks to protect the interest of Ghanaians by passing the Bill. The passage of the Bill will address such issues and also provide clarity, certainty in the key requirements for the provision of virtual asset services in the Country.

Combatting Money Laundering, Terrorism and Proliferation Financing

The Committee noted that the passage of the Bill will complement our concerted and relentless efforts towards combatting money laundering, terrorism and proliferation financing, particularly in the provision of virtual asset services in the Country.

Establishment of a Coordinating Committee for Implementation

The Bill provides for the establishment of a coordinating committee comprising representatives from the Bank of Ghana, the Securities and Exchange Commission, the Ministry of Finance, the Cyber Security Authority and the Financial Intelligence Centre. The committee would be required to review and coordinate the implementation of the provisions in the Bill by the relevant regulatory authorities.

Conclusion and Recommendation

After careful consideration, the Committee is of the view that a legal framework is necessary for the effective regulation and supervision of virtual asset service providers in the Country. The Committee, therefore, recommends to the House to adopt its report and pass the Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill, 2025.

Respectfully submitted.

Mr Speaker, we are unable to control this very emerging trend and even mobile money transactions in our country. So, if there is no regulation in place to deal with such matters, it poses a great challenge to all of us. We have about US\$4.1 trillion investment in the wallet, yet there is no regulation managing it, and if there are issues, it becomes very challenging for people to even identify who did what. It is about time we put in place this regulation to monitor the space.

Mr Speaker, with these few observations, I call on Members to support this Bill to get it passed for us to have a legal framework to regulate the space for all of us.

Thank you very much for the opportunity.

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I will give the floor to Hon Kennedy Nyarko Osei.

Mr Kennedy Nyarko Osei (NPP — Akim Swedru): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I think the Bill has come at the right time. I, for instance, had the opportunity to sit in one of the World Bank meetings in Washington, and this issue was raised.

Mr Speaker, this virtual asset service provider like cryptocurrencies make billions of dollars without paying taxes to any country. People are using cryptocurrencies to buy huge assets somewhere and they are not paying anything to the state. Ghana is losing a lot of revenues, and I think this Bill will provide the needed platform for us to regulate the sector so that Government will be able to get the revenue that it deserves.

Mr Speaker, if you look at the amount of money—the last time I was reading about it, Ghana is losing more than a billion dollars every year because instead of people carrying the money to do physical transactions, they are doing everything virtually. And I think this Bill will help us regulate the entire sector to ensure that those people who transact

using cryptocurrencies and other financial instruments online pay the required revenues or taxes to the state so that we can have enough money.

So, Mr Speaker, I think all of us need to support this Bill and get it done. With these few words, I want to thank you for giving me the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Kennedy Nyarko Osei.

I will listen to Hon Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama first, then I will come to Hon Isaac Adongo, and then, based on the sense of the House, we would draw the curtains down on the Bill and make progress.

Yes, Hon Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama.

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama (NPP — Walewale): Mr Speaker, the Report of the Finance Committee before us seeks the approval of this House for the passage of this important Bill.

Mr Speaker, currently, our financial architecture or Ghana's financial market is regulated by three basic laws. We have the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Act (Act 918), the Payment Systems and Services Act (Act 987), and the Anti-Money Laundering Act, 2020 (Act 1044). These legal frameworks address challenges of payment system in respect of the traditional payment systems. But there is an emerging financial sector, a financial world in which Ghana is not an island. Ghana is part of that global financial architecture and that is the

digital economy. The money involved in the financial volumes traded in terms of the digital economy, is so huge that Ghana is losing out in a lot of financial gains that will have come to the account.

Mr Speaker, this country is preparing for the third round of mutual evaluation on money laundering, tourism financing, and proliferation financing. The measure of our country's preparedness to deal with money laundering, tourism financing, and proliferation financing is at the core of this Bill.

Mr Speaker, the Committee has had extensive engagement with the Ministry of Finance, the Bank of Ghana, and the Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC) who are co-sponsoring this Bill. They have explained in *extenso* the rationale of this Bill, and I think that the Report captures the brevity and the broad contours of the rationale of this Bill. But there is something that is more important that we need to advert our minds to in terms of the digital economy. We are told of the participation of the youth, and even sometimes Members of Parliament in this particular industry where they see cryptocurrencies as a safe haven for the investment of their financial instruments, a way of diversifying their financial portfolio. They are doing it at a risk, because we do not know when next a crisis will hit.

Mr Speaker, imagine that I have one million dollars in cryptocurrency transactions, without any legal framework, it is a great risk for the country. I think that, this House will have to approach this Bill with alacrity.

2:23 p.m.

Mr Speaker, the last thing I would want to touch on is that, when one looks at transactions within the digital world, people are now using cryptocurrency as a store of value. When we talk about the stability of our currency, Mr Speaker, the fact is that the Ghanaian cedi is at the mercy of the United States dollar because we do not have diversified ways of trading. If I want to buy goods and services in China, and I have my wallet with digital currency, I could easily transfer it to another jurisdiction. But without rules guiding this, people will run away with our money.

So, Mr Speaker, for me, and from the Committee's perspective, I feel the Bank of Ghana could not have brought this Bill at a better time. But we must note that the initiative to implement digital transactions and the Virtual Asset Service Providers Bill started in the last administration, and that the Bank of Ghana, realising this threat as far back as August 2024, issued guidelines for financial and digital transactions. This is a continuation of that initiative, and I think a bipartisan approach and support for this Bill are very important to bring it to the light of day.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I support the adoption of the Report of the Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Isaac Adongo.

Mr Isaac Adongo (NDC—Bolgatanga Central): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, it is refreshing to realise that there appears to be bipartisan support for this Bill. We live in a fast-growing world. The days of the cowry shells are gone, and even the days of using physical cash are fast-eroding. And that fintech and digital transactions will now rule the world; we are talking about billions of dollars. But it also puts this country at a major risk; the risk of not being compliant with anti-money laundering activities, the risk of Ghana becoming a safe haven for terrorist financing, and also the possibility of another “NAM1” emerging in our country. It is for this reason that we need to formalise the digital ecosystem and ensure that we are prepared legally and functionally to be able to deal with the threats that this poses, and also to ensure that in addressing the risk, we are taking advantage of the opportunities that it presents in terms of job creation and raking a lot of government revenue to support development.

So, Mr Speaker, it is very clear that this Bill has been long coming, and this House cannot afford to let this opportunity slip by. I, therefore, call on my Colleagues to support this Bill so that we can proceed to develop the legal framework that will support the emergence of this industry.

Mr Speaker, I so support this Bill.

Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

First and foremost, I believe that the world is changing, and the young ones are currently getting on board with this new digital currency, especially crypto. We have other forms of this currency. Mr Speaker, Ghana has even delayed in coming out with these guidelines to regulate this space. Initially, when crypto started, people thought that it was only used for bad things. But today, big banks and companies are moving to crypto because of its use in tokenisation.

Mr Speaker, one of the biggest challenges we have in this country is the documentation of our lands. All over the world now, they are trying to tokenise, or trying to portion land into pieces and be able to still track them in an area or a system that is peer-to-peer, that is not centrally controlled. And I believe that this is one area that Ghana has to now regulate. Therefore, I believe that everyone here should support it and get the Bank of Ghana involved as quickly as possible to make sure that it survives.

Mr Speaker, if we take the American economy with its huge debt, it is all moving to crypto. Even the U.S. Government is moving to crypto to be able to manage some of its debts through stablecoins and others. All over the world, because of the weaponisation of the dollar along the way, people are now moving either into gold or crypto. And I

believe that since Ghana is not an island on its own, it is time we also get involved. In fact, I still say that we have delayed because about three years ago, the Bank of Ghana issued a statement saying that people doing crypto were doing so at their own risk.

Today, we are happy that they have come up with a regulation. And I believe that without being partisan, we should be able to sit down and get the Bill worked out and ensure that this regulation comes into fruition.

With these few words, Mr Speaker, I believe that we should support and get work going.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Deputy Minister for Finance, you have the floor.

Mr Ampem: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I am excited that every Member in this House seems to support the idea of regulating the virtual asset industry. I would want to excite my good Brother, Kabiru, by confirming that, yes, this process started in the previous regime. In 2024, the Bank of Ghana conducted extensive stakeholder engagement and subsequently issued guidelines to guide users of this virtual asset. However, we all know that guidelines are not enough. It is not adequate to regulate the sector. So, it is important that we have a robust Act that will help protect all users.

Mr Speaker, I just want to give this information. Last year, Ghana recorded over US\$6 billion in cryptocurrency alone, according to Chainalysis. And this year, the figure has hit US\$10 billion. So, this shows how exposed our financial system is to the virtual asset sector. So, it is important that we regulate it to protect users and also to generate revenue to develop this country. I am happy that we are receiving this support. I urge all Members to pay attention so that we can go through clause by clause to pass this Bill.

Also, in January next year, we are subjecting ourselves to the third round of mutual evaluation. It is important that we demonstrate as a country that we are ready to fight money laundering. We are ready to fight terrorism financing and all the associated risks that come with it.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Virtual Assets Service Providers Bill, 2025, accordingly read a Second time.

The Speaker: Hon Members, the Virtual Assets Service Providers Bill, 2025 is now at the Consideration Stage.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I want to draw the attention of the Frontbench. They should look at their empty seats.

2:33 p.m.

I do not want to evoke constitutional — *[Interruption]* Mr Speaker, we would not agree. They should go and bring their

Members to pass their Bill. Look at all these empty seats. Yesterday, they had a field day, but today it would not happen. We are against—They should go and get their Members to add up to their numbers. Majority Chief Whip and the Deputy Majority Whips, where are they? Do they see their empty seats? We told them that they would need us. They said the Minority should walk away and now they need us to work on their Bill.

Mr Speaker, they need us. They should go and get their Members to add up to their numbers. They have 189 Members and they cannot marshal half of that. Where is their Chief Whip? He is nowhere to be found. The Deputy Leader is pleading and they are saying they do not need the Minority. Now they need a Minority. Now, they appreciate the power of the Minority. They need us and we all need one another as well — *[Interruption]*. What are they going to say? They should sit down and look behind them, all the seats are empty and they want to pass a Bill. We are not in government, they are.

Mr Speaker, we cannot take the decision. I do not want to come under Order 104 and invoke anything. But they should whip some numbers. They should call their Members to come. The President is watching them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Virtual Assets Service Providers Bill, 2025 is at the Consideration Stage.

BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

2:43 p.m.

**Virtual Asset Service
Providers Bill, 2025**

Clause 1 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Chairperson is here and he is on his phone while his Bill is under consideration— *[Interruption]* No, he is the Chairperson. No, the Chairperson is here and he must move—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, have you now withdrawn the permission for the Vice Chairperson to conduct the Business?

Clause 2 to 5 ordered to stand part of the Bill

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Order! Order!

All Hon Members standing should kindly resume their seats. The Hon Member in the white shirt, why are you turning your back to the Mace. Hon Members, let us take note of the rules. You cannot turn your back to the Mace.

Clause 6 to 10 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member—

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth: Thank you.

Mr Speaker, this is a very important Bill but we have the report of the Committee on the console, but the Bill is not attached to it. We are asking to amend proposals, we are asking for consideration and we do not even know what is happening in this House, because we do not have the Bill.

Mr Speaker, this is a very important Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, with all due respect, I am reliably informed by the Table that for some time now, each Member has a copy of this particular Bill — *[Uproar]*. Further, Hon Members, Order!

I have been in this House for some time. When a Bill is under consideration, and you do not have a copy, all you need to do is to request the Table Office to make a copy available for you. That has been the practice.

Mr Addo-Kenneth: Mr Speaker, thank you but these matters keep going on, especially for us who are new in this House. I have been consistent in my appeal to you that in a lot of cases, we are not so — these are very important matters that we need to go through, find out from the industry players, take advice as legislators, so that we can make meaningful contributions.

Mr Speaker, in a lot of cases, I have made this point that Bills and documents are just put on the console, and when we come here, we have less than 30 minutes to go through and look at it. Meanwhile, we have emails. We have emails that these Bills can be sent to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, please listen carefully. I have no ground to doubt the Table Office that this Bill has been distributed, not today, not yesterday, but for some time now. This Bill has been on the Order Paper for second reading for more than a week.

Yes, Hon Minister for Communication?

Minister for Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations (Mr Samuel Nartey George): Mr Speaker, thank you. The gentleman who just spoke said that for new Members, and we can understand that, because the practice of the House is that when Bills are tabled, and this has been on the *Order Paper* for a whole week, the Bills have been sent to their pigeonholes over a week ago — [*Uproar*]— they are new to the House. They should take their time and understand the practice of the House.

Mr Speaker, it is important that we understand one thing. There is a reason for which Parliament has gone electronic. We are dealing with a Virtual Asset Service provider's Bill. It is a virtual Bill. Members want to deal with

paper every time. Why? Move digital and do not be analogue.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, this is not a matter for debate. So, if you are so interested in the Bill, contact the Clerks-at-the-Table and a copy will be made available to you. I expect all other Members standing to kindly resume their seats.

Hon Majority Leader, any indication as to where we should stop and do a Committee of the Whole?

Mr Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I have checked, and the reason for which there are no contentious issues is because the relevant Committees went through it thoroughly and proffered some amendments. Those amendments were incorporated and the Bill reproduced with the amendments already incorporated. That is why there should not be any issues.

Mr Speaker, if we can just get up to clause 50, then we can take a break from there.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, it was not for nothing that the Winnowing Committee was put together. Even though the relevant Committees may have dealt with the Bill, I was just trying to relate to the Vice Chairperson of the Committee. We need to make good use of the Winnowing Committee. I am a member of the Winnowing Committee and I do not remember there was a meeting called on this matter. That is not

to say that anybody wants to put an impediment. But we are saying that let us make good use of the Winnowing Committee. There are a number of Colleagues who are first-time Members who also wish to learn. So, let us take this into consideration and make good use of the Winnowing Committee going forward.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, let me also place it on record that mostly, the Winnowing Committee will set in when there are multiple amendments to the Bill. Then the Presiding Officer can refer those amendments to the Winnowing Committee so that the Winnowing Committee will deal decisively with those amendments to reduce the workload on the Floor. Hon Members, these days, we have been asking that the Leadership of the Committee on Constitutional and Legal Affairs, who are mostly Members of the Winnowing Committee, join the relevant Committees to look at Bills.

Now, when that is done by a way of some practice, the amendment at those levels will be referred to the AG's Department, who in turn integrate it into the Bill. And then the Bill comes very clean. Hence, it has very little or no amendment to the Bill.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I will not contest that except to add that you would recall when we were taking — there was a particular Bill, I do not remember, maybe Hon Kabiru would wish to remind me, and you had counselled, that the Chief Whip taps into all the Members

who have shown potential in the making of the Bill. We defer to you when it comes to these matters. I have seen your exploits when it comes to lawmaking in this House. The danger is that we should look at the attrition rate and how we can get Members who have shown the interest and potential in lawmaking. I do not want to put out any names but there are notable names on both Sides, the Hon Member for Yendi, Hon Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama, and a few others. We must consciously get them onto the Winnowing Committee.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, it is Hon Kabiru's Committee that considered this Bill. Hon Kabiru Mahama is part of the Finance Committee and he attests to the fact that he was part of the Finance Committee that gave consideration to this Bill.

Dr Kabiru Mahama, is that not right?

Dr A. K. T. Mahama: Mr Speaker, that is very right. It is right that the Committee considered it, and it is also right that most of the proposed amendments have been factored in but the issue is that the new version of those amendments has not been served Members. That is just the only issue but the previous Bill, I think every Member had a copy of it. We went through it and proposed some amendments. Those amendments were incorporated into the new version, which is before this House. I think that is the only part.

Mr Speaker, the point that was made by my Leader is the fact that Winnowing

is a place for us and other Members to learn. So, he is just saying that you should let us use it to nurture the talents of Parliament.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, I understand, but what is the meaning of Winnowing? If the Bill is clean, what are you going to winnow? That is the point. Dr Kabiru Mahama, I can assure you that those who are agitating that they do not have a copy of the Bill do not have a copy of the old one too before them. They really do not have it before them.

2:53 p.m.

So, Hon Members, the practice is that whatever document you find in your pigeon holes, take a little time out of your schedule to read them.

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, before I move to clause 11, as you saw, we invited all Members from both Sides to join the Committee. So, the amendment they proposed incorporated everything in the Bill, and it is not like we are just rubber-stamping everything.

So, Mr Speaker, on clause 11, there was no advertised amendment.

Clause 11 to 25 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I would direct the Drafters to check the heading for clause 11 and clause 19.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, there is an understanding that we exit at

Clause 25 and break into the Committee of the Whole.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Leadership?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, indeed, we had agreed that we would do up to clause 25, and then abandon the Consideration Stage, and go into the Committee of the Whole.

3:03 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

This will bring us temporarily to the end of the Consideration Stage.

Hon Members, in the meantime, let me acknowledge the presence of students from Home of Glory Academy, led by Mr Emmanuel Okine, the proprietor of the school. They are from Domeabra Obom, and they are 74 in number. May I use the opportunity to welcome you to the Parliament of Ghana, and to indicate that in Parliament, we do not clap. We say *Hear! Hear!*

Thank you very much. You may resume your seats. May you have a fruitful visit to Parliament.

[Pupil from Home of Glory Academy were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Having reconstituted the House into Committee of the Whole, we may call on the Marshal to make sure that the Gallery is cleared.

3:05 p.m. — *Sitting suspended.*

5.30 p.m. — *Sitting resumed.*

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I think we can adjourn at this point. I mean, after yesterday's wrestling, that Side is tired. We need to give them time to recover.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Leader, I think if you move a Motion for adjournment, they will oppose it; that Motion is likely to be opposed. So, have we done more than five hours?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, in any case, let me move that this House

adjourns till noon tomorrow for the resumption of Business.

Mr George Kwame Aboagye: Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am surprised. Hon Aboagye should have opposed this Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 5:34 p.m. till Thursday, 11th December, 2025 at 12:00 noon.

Editor's Note

This Official Report was corrected by the House on 18th December, 2025.